CARD 1 OF 8 5-YEAR RULE **QUESTION**

A riser gauge is stamped **2019**. What does NFPA 25 say has to happen to it every 5 years?

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CARD 2 OF 8 3% ACCURACY **QUESTION**

You compare a **0–300 psi** gauge to a calibrated one. How far off can it read before it fails?

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CARD 3 OF 8 MONTHLY CHECK **QUESTION**

What does the **monthly** gauge inspection actually check, and which systems does it cover?

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CARD 4 OF 8 WATER PRESSURE **QUESTION**

How often do **water pressure** gauges get checked for normal supply pressure, and what counts as “normal”?

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*FSM · Sprinkler Fact Cards — NFPA 25 (2020) Pressure Gauges · sheet 1 FRONT — print double-sided, **flip on LONG edge** · cut on the dashed lines*

CARD 2 OF 8 3% ACCURACY **ANSWER**

3% of full scale = 9 psi.

Off by more than 9 psi → **recalibrate or replace** it.

The 3% is of the gauge's **full scale** (300 psi), not of the pressure it's reading.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

Trap: taking 3% of the 60 psi on the dial (1.8 psi) and failing a good gauge.

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CARD 1 OF 8 5-YEAR RULE **ANSWER**

One of two things:

- **Replace it**, or
- **Test it** against a **calibrated** gauge.

Either one satisfies the 5-year requirement.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

Trap: "5 years means swap it." A comparison test against a calibrated gauge is just as valid.

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CARD 4 OF 8 WATER PRESSURE **ANSWER**

Quarterly.

Annex on "normal": compare to design info, the known water supply and past readings. A reading at or below the demand on the **hydraulic placard** is **not** normal. It points to a supply problem.

Annex: the gauge above the check valve can read **higher** than the one below from trapped pressure surges.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13 · Annex A

Trap: calling a higher top gauge a bad gauge. Trapped pressure above the clapper is common.

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CARD 3 OF 8 MONTHLY CHECK **ANSWER**

That the gauge works and isn't damaged. Cracked glass, a bent needle, a needle stuck on zero.

Annex: the gauge inspection frequencies apply to **every system type** the standard covers, wet or dry.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13 · Annex A

On the job: a gauge fogged inside so you can't read the needle is not operable. Write it up.

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sheet 1 BACK — columns are intentionally mirrored for long-edge duplex · card numbers must match front to back

CARD 5 OF 8 AIR & NITROGEN **QUESTION**

Dry pipe system: how often are the **air (or nitrogen) pressure** gauges inspected, and what can stretch that out?

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CARD 6 OF 8 QUICK-OPENING DEVICE **QUESTION**

A dry pipe valve has a **quick-opening device** (accelerator) with its own gauge. What should that gauge show?

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CARD 7 OF 8 FREEZER SYSTEMS **QUESTION**

A dry or preaction system protects a **freezer**. The air gauge near the **compressor** reads higher than the gauge above the valve. What does it mean, and what do you do?

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CARD 8 OF 8 MAIN DRAIN TEST **QUESTION**

During the **annual main drain test** you read the gauges. What drop in **full flow pressure** means you have to find out why?

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CARD 6 OF 8 QUICK-OPENING DEVICE **ANSWER**

It should match the system-side gauge on the dry pipe valve.

If they don't match, something is wrong with the device or its connection.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

On the job: system side reads 40 psi, the accelerator reads 0. They should match. Find out why before you leave.

CARD 5 OF 8 AIR & NITROGEN **ANSWER**

Monthly, to confirm normal air or nitrogen pressure.

Quarterly is allowed when the air pressure supervision reports to a **constantly attended** location.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

Trap: applying quarterly because there's a low-air switch. It has to report somewhere that's watched around the clock.

CARD 8 OF 8 MAIN DRAIN TEST **ANSWER**

10% lower than the acceptance test or earlier tests.

Then: identify the cause and correct it if needed.

Quarterly: if the only water supply runs through a **backflow preventer** or **pressure-reducing valve**, test at least one system downstream of it every quarter.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

Trap: no old numbers to compare to. Without them the 10% check can't be made, so write the readings down every time.

CARD 7 OF 8 FREEZER SYSTEMS **ANSWER**

Likely an ice plug forming in the air line. These two gauges get compared **monthly**.

Fix: take that air line out of service and open the **alternate** line to equalize.

Then: open up the removed line, clear the ice, put it back together as the next alternate.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

Trap: blaming the gauge. A higher reading on the compressor side is the warning.

sheet 2 BACK — columns are intentionally mirrored for long-edge duplex · card numbers must match front to back